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US, Iran near deal

Pakistan says terms OK'd in 1st phase of tentative agreement

By Munir Ahmed, Michelle L. Price and Russ Bynum
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ISLAMABAD — Pakistan's prime minister said Friday that the United States and Iran have agreed to word-ing of an agreement aimed at ending their war in the Middle East and that media-tors were working with both sides to finalize a deal.

Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif said the U.S. and Iran have reached a “final, agreed upon text.”

He said Pakistan, which has taken the lead in medi-ation efforts, was working with the warring countries on next steps.

“Peace has never been this close as it is now,” Sharif said in a post on X.

The apparent break-through in negotiations comes after Iran exchanged fire with the U.S. and Israel over three days this week, threatening to return the Middle East to full-scale war.

Iranian Foreign Minis-ter Abbas Araghchi said Friday that an agreement “has never been closer” in a post on X. President Donald Trump, who has said multi-ple times in recent weeks that the countries were on the cusp of a deal, shared Araghchi's post on his own social media.

The war launched by the U.S. and Israel on Feb. 28 has rattled the Middle East and virtually shut down oil and natural gas shipments from the Persian Gulf. A fragile ceasefire has been in place since April 7.

Araghchi told Iranian state TV on Friday that both sides were working toward signing an initial agreement declar-ing an end to the war “on all fronts, including Lebanon.”

Israel has been fighting the

See **IRAN** on Page A2

Tornadoes rip through Illinois, Indiana, leaving homes leveled in their wake

No deaths reported amid violent end to two-day outbreak of severe weather

TOPPLED



Downed power lines, trees and debris line Broadway in Merrillville, Indiana, on Friday after a tornado. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

By Tess Kenny, Rebecca Johnson and Allison Kiehl
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Maria Williams was up as the sun rose early Friday morning, inspecting the damage at her family's home in her blue scrubs. Broken wood and foam insulation scattered the front lawn, and a large tree torn out by its roots rested in the grass. The roof was in shambles.

“Four of my five kids have grown up in this house,” Williams said, her eyes pool-ing with tears. “So (I’m) just trying to figure out what it’s gonna look like again. If I can even rebuild it.”

It had been just hours since a tornado tore through Merrillville on Thursday evening, leveling hundreds

of buildings but causing only one minor injury. The north-west Indiana town was one of several communities outside Chicago hit by tornadoes Thursday night, which came at the tail end of a two-day bout of severe weather that swept through the Midwest.

The National Weather Service's Chicago office said it is conducting storm surveys over the next few days to gauge exactly how many tornadoes touched down Thursday, as well as their intensity.

Preliminary results as of Friday afternoon showed an EF-1 tornado in Bartlett and in central Livingston County, including near Dwight. They also found EF-3 damage in Porter County, Indiana, and

See **TORNADOES** on Page A4



A worker with a chain saw cuts away limbs from fallen trees away from a car at 116th and Elizabeth streets in Chicago on Friday following Thursday's storm that dropped tornadoes across the region. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



Jackson Leggett, 19, of Newark, stands on the porch of his home on Thursday. **JOSH BOLAND/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

‘Piece taken out of my life’

Kendall County teenager who faced felony charge for allegedly joking about senior prank, burning school files federal lawsuit

By Rebecca Johnson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

It was the day after the senior pranks when a Kend-all County teenager and his friends were laughing about the annual tradition in their English class.

That year, all in good fun, Jackson Leggett said some of the seniors at Newark Community High School had toilet-papered the principal's house and parked speed boats at the school.

They also chatted about a rumor going around about

potential vandalism at the school, which Leggett said he tried to quash with the sarcastic quip, “What do you think I’m gonna do? Burn the school down?”

This October 2024 conversation — which Leggett intended as a joke — completely upended his senior year, according to a lawsuit Leggett filed last month in federal court against the school district, the superintendent, his teacher, Kendall County and a sher-iff's deputy.

The suit alleges that

the then 17-year-old was wrongfully arrested, falsely charged with felony disorderly conduct and forced to miss out on many senior year milestones over what should have been treated as a “minor school disciplinary issue” at most.

The now 19-year-old also told the Tribune he was left “constantly nervous and scared” for months, and that his reputation was damaged in the small town, located about an hour and a half drive

See **LAWSUIT** on Page A2

West Suburban fully shut down

Oak Park ordered the hospital building shut Thursday after the last functioning elevator stopped working — forcing the remaining patients elsewhere. **Business**

Independents sour on Trump

Independents have grown increasingly unhappy with the president during his second term, a new poll finds, particularly those without a college degree. **Business**

Williams embraces spotlight

Whether handling off-field appearances or a huddle, Bears quarterback Caleb Williams is keenly aware that a growing number of eyes are on him. **Sports**

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WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY H: 85 L: 61
SUN. H: 72 L: 57
MON. H: 75 L: 58
Complete details on Page A8

INDEX

Almanac A6
Arts & Living B7
Comics B10-11
Crossword B11
Editorials A5
Horoscope B10
Nation & World B4
Sudoku B11
Television B9

179th year No. 164
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